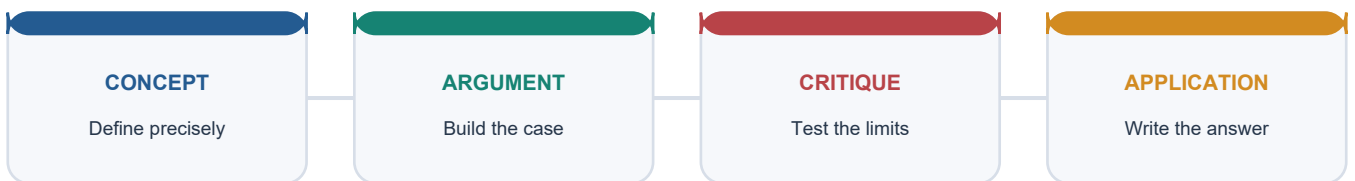


SOLVED PRACTICE WORKBOOK

Ideology and End of Ideology - Solved Practice Workbook

Solved practice workbook: 32 original MCQs with option-specific explanations, verified PYQ status and six original GS Mains models.

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / WORKBOOK INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

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Ideology and End of Ideology - Solved Practice Workbook

Subject: Political Theory **Target stages:** UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains only **Primary ownership:** GS-II conceptual foundations **Approval:** pending explicit user approval

WORKBOOK GUIDE

- Attempt Questions 1-24 as hard core diagnostics and Questions 25-32 as remedial traps.
- Record the reason for eliminating each wrong option before reading the four option-specific explanations.
- The key is a fixed A -> B -> C -> D rotation; cover it while attempting, because the rotation is a production standard and must never replace elimination reasoning.
- For Mains, write within the stated GS ceiling: 150 words for 10 marks and 250 words for 15 marks.
- No direct owned Topic 02 Prelims/GS Mains PYQ is verified; no question owned by another UPSC paper is imported or relabelled.
- The generic 20-mark optional-style model is N/A here: Political Theory is a UPSC Prelims and General Studies Mains foundation, not an optional paper.

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

Practice design

- Questions 1-24 are hard core GS/Prelims diagnostics; Questions 25-32 are remedial close-option repairs.
- Formats are deliberately varied: definition control, multi-statement, sequence, matching, chronology, elimination, application, evidence and inference.
- The correct option rotates strictly A -> B -> C -> D, repeated eight times across the 32 questions, giving 8 A, 8 B, 8 C and 8 D.
- Because the key is a fixed rotation it carries no diagnostic value: options are matched for register and length, so an answer can only be reached by reasoning about content.
- Each of the 128 options carries its own question-specific explanation and each question closes with a distinct examiner trap.

MCQ 1

Which statement captures the two principal meanings of ideology used in the chapter?

- A. A doctrine held by a party, and a science that studies how ideas form and become distorted.
- B. A constitutional programme, and an empirical survey of voter preferences.
- C. A moral theory of private conduct, and a legal code enforced by the state.
- D. A historical narrative of past regimes, together with a statistical technique for predicting election outcomes.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A correctly joins ideology as committed idea-set with ideology as science of ideas.
- **B:** B substitutes institutional and polling categories for the chapter's two meanings.
- **C:** C shifts the concept into private morality and positive law.
- **D:** D confuses ideology with historiography and electoral forecasting.

Examiner trap: Remembering only ideology-as-belief and missing the older science-of-ideas meaning.

MCQ 2

Why is ideology described as action-oriented?

- A. It avoids prescriptions altogether and confines itself to the detached description of observed political facts.
- B. It supplies a cause, identifies goals and opponents, and mobilises adherents for political action.
- C. It becomes valid only after courts recognise its principles as legally enforceable.
- D. It treats commitment as purely intellectual and excludes sacrifice or collective mobilisation.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A describes detached inquiry rather than mobilising ideology.
- **B:** B states the mechanism connecting belief, identity, goals and collective action.
- **C:** C invents a legal-validity requirement.
- **D:** D contradicts Gauba's emphasis on commitment and sacrifice.

Examiner trap: Treating ideology as a passive collection of opinions rather than an organising frame.

MCQ 3

Which distinction best separates the social origin of a theory from its validity?

- A. A claim becomes valid whenever it emerges from an oppressed or excluded social group.
- B. A claim becomes invalid whenever its historical and class context can be identified.
- C. Context explains why a claim arose; evidence and reasons determine what should be accepted.
- D. Validity depends on whether a doctrine's adherents succeed in winning and then retaining political power.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A turns social position into automatic truth.
- **B:** B commits the genetic fallacy by treating origin as refutation.
- **C:** C preserves Sabine's contextual insight while retaining critical evaluation.
- **D:** D substitutes political victory for epistemic and normative testing.

Examiner trap: Using genealogy as either automatic proof or automatic disproof.

MCQ 4

Destutt de Tracy's original use of 'ideology' referred primarily to:

- A. A proletarian doctrine designed to organise and guide continuing revolutionary class struggle.
- B. A totalitarian doctrine used by the state to impose one final and unquestionable political truth.
- C. A welfare-state consensus that reduces conflict between established Left and Right parties.
- D. A science of ideas grounded in empirical learning and the study of how ideas are formed.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A describes Lenin's later political use.
- **B:** B belongs to Popper-Arendt analysis.
- **C:** C belongs to end-of-ideology writers.
- **D:** D accurately states Tracy's epistemological project.

Examiner trap: Projecting the later pejorative meaning back onto the term's original coinage.

MCQ 5

Francis Bacon is relevant to ideology critique because his account of 'idols':

- A. Bacon showed how false impressions or idols can distort knowledge before Tracy coined ideology.
- B. Bacon equated every strong political commitment with totalitarian domination and terror.
- C. Bacon defended inherited group faith against observation and against every other form of empirical inquiry.
- D. Bacon anticipated the welfare-state and industrial-convergence account of ideological decline.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A gives the correct anticipatory connection to distorted ideas.
- **B:** B imports a twentieth-century totalitarian argument.
- **C:** C reverses Bacon's demand for careful observation.
- **D:** D connects Bacon to an unrelated mid-century thesis.

Examiner trap: Confusing an intellectual precursor with a later theorist of political ideology.

MCQ 6

In Gauba's dimensions table, ideology as an accepted set of ideas differs from ideology as science of ideas because the former is mainly:

- A. The former is critical and open to questioning, while the latter requires settled political faith.
- B. The former is detached from politics, while the latter serves only partisan political action.
- C. The former is committed, closed and mobilising; the latter investigates, criticises and questions.
- D. The former concerns private beliefs, while the latter alone concerns public authority and power.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A describes the science-of-ideas side.
- **B:** B correctly contrasts faith/action with examination/openness.
- **C:** C again describes critical inquiry, not committed ideology.
- **D:** D ignores ideology's explicit political role.

Examiner trap: Reversing the two columns of the dimensions table.

MCQ 7

Marx's account of false consciousness primarily explains how:

- A. social consciousness always advances faster than productive forces.
- B. all ideas are deliberate lies invented by individual rulers.
- C. dominant material relations can appear natural and universal through ruling ideas.
- D. proletarian ideology is necessarily identical with bourgeois ideology.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A reverses Marx's lag-of-consciousness account.
- **B:** B reduces ideology to conscious deception, which is too narrow.
- **C:** C captures structural distortion and dominant-class interest.
- **D:** D ignores Marx's class analysis and Lenin's later extension.

Examiner trap: Reducing structural false consciousness to propaganda or personal dishonesty.

MCQ 8

Which qualification is essential when using Marx's concept of ideology?

- A. Material conditions have no connection with consciousness.
- B. Ideology is merely a synonym for any political principle.
- C. Only oppressed groups produce distorted consciousness.
- D. Distortion can be socially produced without every adherent consciously lying.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A rejects the materialist basis of Marx's account.
- **B:** B empties the concept of its critical content.
- **C:** C wrongly exempts one side from social conditioning.
- **D:** D correctly separates structural distortion from intentional deceit.

Examiner trap: Assuming false consciousness requires a secret conspiracy.

MCQ 9

How does Lenin alter the mainly pejorative Marxian use of ideology?

- A. He treats ideology as class consciousness generally, including proletarian scientific socialism.
- B. He rejects class struggle as irrelevant once a socialist political organisation has been established.
- C. He restricts ideology to religious, nationalist and communal doctrines rather than class politics.
- D. He identifies ideology only with state terror and a totalitarian monopoly over political truth.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A correctly broadens ideology into a neutral class-consciousness category that includes the proletariat's scientific socialism.
- **B:** B contradicts Lenin's own reason for proletarian ideology, namely that class struggle continues for a very long time during the socialist phase.
- **C:** C invents a narrow subject restriction.
- **D:** D belongs to totalitarian closure, not Lenin's semantic revision.

Examiner trap: Forgetting that Lenin makes ideology a more neutral class-consciousness category.

MCQ 10

Lukács's position is best distinguished from a simple 'all ideology is false' view because he:

- A. He argues that ideological struggle can entirely replace material organisation and class struggle.
- B. He treats consciousness as class-situated and recognises Marxism as proletarian ideology.
- C. He reduces ideology to the conscious intentions and private dishonesty of individual capitalists.
- D. He argues that social location has no significant influence on the development of political thought.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A ignores his warning against substituting ideology for class struggle.
- **B:** B states Lukács's wider class-consciousness position.

- **C:** C individualises a structural argument.
- **D:** D denies his core dependence-of-thought thesis.

Examiner trap: Missing Lukács's non-pejorative use while also missing his warning about material struggle.

MCQ 11

Which statement reflects Mannheim's criticism of a narrow Marxian ideology critique?

- A. Only economic classes shape thought, and Marxism alone remains outside all social conditioning.
- B. Every idea is false merely because every thinker occupies a social and historical location.
- C. All thought, including Marxism, is socially shaped; generations and other groups also influence it.
- D. Objective knowledge belongs automatically to whichever group currently controls political power in a society.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A states the narrow position Mannheim criticises.
- **B:** B converts social conditioning into total scepticism.
- **C:** C captures his generalisation beyond one class and one ideology.
- **D:** D conflicts with his problem of perspectival knowledge.

Examiner trap: Treating Mannheim as merely extending ruling-class critique rather than reflexively applying it.

MCQ 12

Mannheim's ideology-utopia distinction is that:

- A. Ideology is scientific knowledge, while utopia consists only of verified empirical observations.
- B. Ideology is inherently revolutionary, while utopia defends institutions and the existing status quo.
- C. Both terms describe social programmes that have already been fully implemented and tested.
- D. Ideology preserves an existing order; utopia mobilises change through an unrealizable projection.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A confuses political projections with methods of knowledge.
- **B:** B reverses the two concepts.
- **C:** C removes the unrealised character central to utopia.
- **D:** D correctly states conservation versus change within false consciousness.

Examiner trap: Remembering change versus conservation but assigning them to the wrong term.

MCQ 13

Why is Mannheim's 'free-floating intelligentsia' solution controversial?

- A. It risks confusing social origin with validity and granting experts an unaccountable claim to objectivity.
- B. It requires intellectuals to abandon criticism and accept the viewpoint of the strongest class.
- C. It proves that social scientists possess a settled legal and moral entitlement to govern the society they study.
- D. It rejects the possibility of dialogue, comparison or intellectual movement across perspectives.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A states the recorded epistemic and political criticism.
- **B:** B ignores the proposed critical and mediating role.

- **C:** C turns a contested proposal into an established entitlement.
- **D:** D reverses Mannheim's hope for synthesis.

Examiner trap: Accepting the proposed mediator as automatically outside every social location.

MCQ 14

Which reasoning error occurs when a claim is rejected solely because it arose from a privileged class?

- A. A category error between ideology and utopia.
- B. A confusion of the origin of knowledge with its validity.
- C. A failure to distinguish open and totalitarian society.
- D. A reversal of induction and deduction.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A concerns Mannheim's political pair, not the inference error.
- **B:** B identifies the genetic fallacy highlighted by the criticism of Mannheim.
- **C:** C is a regime-type distinction.
- **D:** D is a methodological error unrelated to social origin.

Examiner trap: Treating causal explanation of belief as sufficient logical refutation.

MCQ 15

Popper's open society is characterised chiefly by:

- A. A final state doctrine accepted as authoritative by every citizen and political association.
- B. Administrative efficiency maintained without public information, dissent or policy criticism.
- C. Free information, criticism, revisability and refusal of a political monopoly over truth.
- D. Elimination of every political value, commitment and disagreement from public life.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A describes the closed truth-claim Popper opposes.
- **B:** B retains managerial authority but removes openness.
- **C:** C gives the institutional-epistemic core of the open society.
- **D:** D mistakes openness for value-lessness.

Examiner trap: Equating an open society with an ideology-free or value-free society.

MCQ 16

Arendt's account of totalitarianism adds to a purely doctrinal view by emphasising:

- A. Economic exploitation operating within otherwise competitive and plural political markets.
- B. Peaceful convergence of advanced industrial societies through technical and managerial administration alone.
- C. Constitutional centralisation without ideology, mass mobilisation or coercive organisation.
- D. Ideology combined with terror, organisation and the mobilisation of uprooted and isolated masses.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A narrows the account to class economics.
- **B:** B belongs to convergence writers, not Arendt.

- **C:** C omits terror, ideology and mass atomisation.
- **D:** D captures the ideology-plus-terror mechanism and social conditions.

Examiner trap: Reducing totalitarianism to strong belief without coercive organisation and social conditions.

MCQ 17

Which statement correctly limits the Popper-Arendt critique?

- A. The danger threshold is monopoly truth joined to coercion and the destruction of criticism.
- B. Only ruling-class ideologies can become totalitarian; oppositional ideologies are necessarily open.
- C. Every ideology becomes totalitarian as soon as it inspires loyalty, sacrifice or collective action.
- D. Open societies contain no ideology, public value or organised political commitment.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A gives the required closure-and-coercion threshold.
- **B:** B wrongly exempts oppositional doctrines.
- **C:** C makes ordinary mobilisation equivalent to total domination.
- **D:** D confuses openness with absence of commitment.

Examiner trap: Using 'totalitarian' as a loose synonym for any strongly held ideology.

MCQ 18

Daniel Bell's end-of-ideology claim rested on a perceived consensus around:

- A. Abolition of industrial services and restoration of an agrarian economy in affluent states.
- B. Welfare-state, mixed-economy, pluralist and decentralised-power consensus in the mid-century West.
- C. One-party government and uniform central planning across every advanced industrial society.
- D. The complete disappearance of managers, professionals and technical elites from post-industrial politics.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A contradicts the post-industrial setting.
- **B:** B states Bell's historically bounded convergence package.
- **C:** C substitutes authoritarian uniformity for pluralist consensus.
- **D:** D reverses Bell's emphasis on technical elites.

Examiner trap: Treating Bell's contextual diagnosis as a claim about every society and period.

MCQ 19

Dahrendorf argued that Marx's framework had weakened in post-capitalist society because:

- A. Economic conflict had expanded until it determined every political and social conflict directly.
- B. Political parties had stopped using ideological language, programmes and social identities.
- C. Industrial conflict had become institutionally isolated from wider political conflict.
- D. Legal reform had abolished every class difference and material inequality in post-capitalist society.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A states the opposite of institutional containment.
- **B:** B is neither necessary nor claimed.

- **C:** C correctly captures the separation of industrial and political conflict.
- **D:** D overstates change as complete class abolition.

Examiner trap: Converting the isolation of one conflict arena into the disappearance of social conflict.

MCQ 20

Lipset's 'good society in operation' proposition should be read as:

- A. A universal proof that democracy everywhere had permanently resolved all political conflict.
- B. A constitutional doctrine making welfare provision legally mandatory in every democratic state.
- C. A Leninist argument that workers require scientific-socialist ideology for continued struggle.
- D. A bounded thesis about affluent Western democracy and the narrowing of Left-Right disputes.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A universalises a contextual proposition.
- **B:** B turns political sociology into constitutional law.
- **C:** C connects Lipset to an unrelated Leninist claim.
- **D:** D preserves the intended setting and limited conclusion.

Examiner trap: Removing the affluent Western and mid-century qualifiers.

MCQ 21

Rostow's contribution to the convergence argument was the claim that:

- A. All societies pass through comparable development stages irrespective of their professed ideology.
- B. The social origin of a belief automatically determines whether its propositions are true.
- C. Totalitarian terror is a necessary condition for industrial take-off and mass consumption.
- D. Political ideology alone determines the timing and the sequence of every stage of a country's economic growth.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A states the universal stage model used against ideological determinism.
- **B:** B concerns sociology of knowledge.
- **C:** C invents a coercive requirement.
- **D:** D reverses Rostow's argument.

Examiner trap: Confusing a common-stage development claim with proof that politics is irrelevant.

MCQ 22

Galbraith's technocratic-convergence thesis highlights:

- A. The disappearance of bureaucracy and professional management from advanced industrial systems.
- B. Centralisation, professionalisation and power shifting towards bureaucratic and technical elites.
- C. The restoration of direct worker control over complex production and administrative organisations.
- D. The supremacy of doctrinal party leaders over managers, specialists and technical organisations.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A reverses the growth of organisation and bureaucracy.
- **B:** B captures the managerial-technocratic mechanism.

- **C:** C is not Galbraith's convergence claim.
- **D:** D reverses the shift away from ideological leadership.

Examiner trap: Equating reduced doctrinal rhetoric with absence of a new managerial power structure.

MCQ 23

Which critic-position match is correct?

- A. Macpherson - market society has already solved equitable distribution.
- B. C. Wright Mills - end-of-ideology writers revive revolutionary Marxism.
- C. Titmuss - concentrated economic power and deprivation remain beneath affluence.
- D. MacIntyre - the end thesis is completely free of ideology.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A reverses Macpherson's distribution criticism.
- **B:** B reverses Mills's charge of status-quo complacency.
- **C:** C accurately states Titmuss's objection.
- **D:** D reverses MacIntyre's self-refutation charge.

Examiner trap: Knowing the critic list but mismatching the substance of their objections.

MCQ 24

Gauba's discussion of Fukuyama should be used as:

- A. A final proof that liberal democracy contains no internal contradictions or unresolved exclusions.
- B. An official contemporary finding that should govern every present political classification.
- C. A rejection of every argument connecting industrial development with ideological convergence.
- D. A later post-1989 extension of convergence claims that still requires critical scrutiny.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A repeats the strong claim without Gauba's caution.
- **B:** B converts an intellectual thesis into official evidence.
- **C:** C misclassifies Fukuyama as an opponent of convergence.
- **D:** D gives the correct historical and critical treatment.

Examiner trap: Citing 'end of history' as settled fact rather than a contested historical thesis.

MCQ 25 - REMEDIAL

A learner writes, 'Ideology always means false consciousness.' What is the best correction?

- A. Incorrect: Gauba includes mobilising and emancipatory ideologies, while Marx supplies one distortion model.
- B. Correct, because every politically committed belief is necessarily distorted and therefore politically harmful.
- C. Correct only when the ideology is articulated by an oppressed or excluded social group.
- D. Incorrect because ideology never concerns material interests, class power or domination.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A preserves the broad category while locating Marx's narrower use.
- **B:** B repeats the blanket error.

- **C:** C reverses the class pattern and still overgeneralises.
- **D:** D removes a major dimension of ideology critique.

Examiner trap: Turning one theorist's use into the exhaustive definition.

MCQ 26 - REMEDIAL

A learner argues, 'Because theory is socially located, it is only ideology.' The best reply is:

- A. Every socially situated political claim is equally true and cannot be compared rationally.
- B. Social location explains a claim's origin, but validity still depends on reasons, evidence and revision.
- C. Theory has no social origin because genuine theoretical work is produced outside history.
- D. Only expert intellectuals can fully escape social location and attain unquestionable objectivity.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A converts situated knowledge into relativism.
- **B:** B correctly separates genealogy from validity-testing.
- **C:** C makes the impossible claim that theory is socially originless.
- **D:** D repeats the contested intelligentsia solution as certainty.

Examiner trap: Using social situatedness to erase all standards of better and worse argument.

MCQ 27 - REMEDIAL

A government calls a distributive choice 'purely technical'. Ideology critique should first ask:

- A. Whether all technical expertise should be rejected as incompatible with democratic politics.
- B. Whether the decision uses sufficiently specialised vocabulary and professional procedures.
- C. Which goals, beneficiaries, risks and alternatives are hidden by the claim of political neutrality.
- D. Whether the policy has followed the correct administrative process, irrespective of its goals and distribution.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A confuses criticism of technocratic closure with anti-expertise.
- **B:** B mistakes jargon for neutrality.
- **C:** C identifies the power-and-value questions concealed by technical framing.
- **D:** D does not address the value choices within procedure.

Examiner trap: Opposing technocracy by denying expertise instead of exposing hidden ends.

MCQ 28 - REMEDIAL

Which statement most accurately repairs the end-of-ideology thesis?

- A. Technical elites have no interests because expertise itself guarantees political neutrality.
- B. Older doctrinal conflict may narrow, while value choice and power relocate into managerial or identity forms.
- C. Industrialisation makes political institutions and distributions of power identical in every country.
- D. All ideological conflict ended permanently once welfare institutions expanded in the West.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A treats expertise as proof of political innocence.
- **B:** B converts a period claim into permanent law.

- **C:** C overstates convergence as institutional identity.
- **D:** D gives the qualified relocation thesis.

Examiner trap: Confusing changed form and reduced salience with disappearance.

MCQ 29 - REMEDIAL

An emancipatory movement uses a shared future vision. Which analytical conclusion is strongest?

- A. Its ideology is automatically false because collective mobilisation requires sacrifice and discipline.
- B. Its ideology is automatically true because the movement represents an oppressed constituency.
- C. Its ideology can organise legitimate claims, but its facts, means and exclusions still require criticism.
- D. Its ideology falls outside political theory because it seeks social and institutional change.

Answer: A

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A combines emancipatory possibility with continued critical testing.
- **B:** B grants automatic truth from social position.
- **C:** C treats mobilisation as automatic falsity.
- **D:** D removes precisely the kind of political action theory must analyse.

Examiner trap: Replacing blanket condemnation with blanket celebration.

MCQ 30 - REMEDIAL

A one-party state claims to embody history's final truth. Which test is most relevant?

- A. Whether the state publicly claims that its programme promotes national development and welfare.
- B. Whether criticism, alternatives and policy revision remain possible, and whether coercion enforces doctrine.
- C. Whether citizens participate in rallies and organisations sponsored by the ruling political party.
- D. Whether the official ideology uses modern economic, scientific and developmental vocabulary.

Answer: B

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A does not establish revisability or freedom.
- **B:** B applies the Popper-Arendt closure and coercion threshold.
- **C:** C can coexist with compulsory mobilisation.
- **D:** D concerns rhetoric rather than institutional openness.

Examiner trap: Mistaking organised participation for an open society.

MCQ 31 - REMEDIAL

Which chronology is correct?

- A. Mannheim -> Marx -> Tracy -> Bell.
- B. Bell -> Bacon -> Lenin -> Popper.
- C. Tracy -> Marx -> Lenin -> Mannheim -> Bell.
- D. Popper -> Tracy -> Arendt -> Marx.

Answer: C

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A places Marx after Mannheim and Tracy last.
- **B:** B begins with a mid-century writer before Bacon and Lenin.

- **C:** C follows the conceptual chronology from science of ideas to class and convergence debates.
- **D:** D places Tracy after Popper and Marx after Arendt.

Examiner trap: Knowing the names but not the sequence of the concept's transformations.

MCQ 32 - REMEDIAL

Which repository-ownership statement is correct for Topic 02?

- **A:** It owns every UPSC question that mentions Marx, ideology, class consciousness or totalitarianism.
- **B:** It converts a question owned by another UPSC paper into a Political Theory question.
- **C:** It supplies GS/Prelims concepts; only directly verified Prelims/GS questions may be owned here.
- **D:** It replaces direct Polity, Governance and current-evidence requirements in GS-II answers.

Answer: D

Option-by-option explanation

- **A:** A ignores direct topic and paper ownership.
- **B:** B violates the no-proxy-routing rule.
- **C:** C confuses conceptual analysis with direct factual ownership.
- **D:** D states the required classification and PYQ firewall.

Examiner trap: Treating conceptual overlap as question ownership.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

VERIFIED UPSC PRELIMS / GS MAINS PYQ STATUS

No direct owned UPSC Prelims or General Studies Mains PYQ is verified for Topic 02 in the repository's routed ledgers. Political Theory is a GS/Prelims conceptual-support subject, and proxy, alias or synthetic PYQ ownership is prohibited. Questions owned by another UPSC paper are not imported. The six questions below are clearly labelled original GS Mains practice.

ORIGINAL GS MAINS PRACTICE WITH MODEL SOLUTIONS

Original GS Mains Model 1 - 10 marks

Question: Explain the two meanings of ideology and distinguish ideology from political theory. Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive *explain* requires the answer to set out the concept, its mechanism and its consequences in a stated order. Fix the boundary of the two meanings of ideology and distinguish ideology from political theory in the opening line, carry the argument on Ideology, Gauba's, Destutt and Tracy's, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that the decisive test is therefore not whether values are present, but whether claims remain open to reasons, counter-evidence and revision.

Model answer (139 words):

Ideology has two meanings in Gauba's account. First, it is a set of ideas accepted by a group and used to justify an order, identify opponents and mobilise action. Second, in Destutt de Tracy's original sense, it is a science of ideas examining how beliefs form and become distorted. Political theory differs mainly in intellectual posture. Ideology begins from commitment and seeks adherence; theory submits claims to evidence, conceptual clarification and normative criticism. Thus, nationalism or environmentalism may organise collective action, while theory asks whether their factual claims, means and goals are defensible. The distinction is qualified: theory arises in historical situations and can become ideological when assumptions are insulated from criticism. Conversely, an ideology may contain emancipatory insight. The decisive test is therefore not whether values are present, but whether claims remain open to reasons, counter-evidence and revision.

Why this earns marks: it obeys explain instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Ideology, Gauba's, Destutt and Tracy's), converts that evidence into analysis of the two meanings of ideology and distinguish ideology from political theory, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that the decisive test is therefore not whether values are present, but whether claims remain open to reasons, counter-evidence and revision. At 139 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 2 - 10 marks

Question: How does Marx's use of ideology differ from Lenin's use of the term? Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive how requires the answer to state the mechanism step by step and show what each step produces. Fix the boundary of does Marx's use of ideology differ from Lenin's use of the term in the opening line, carry the argument on Marx, Material, Ideology and Lenin, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that marx and Lenin therefore share the link between ideas and class struggle, but differ in range: Marx emphasises distortion by ruling ideas, whereas Lenin also legitimises an organised revolutionary ideology.

Model answer (140 words):

Marx uses ideology mainly as a critical concept. Material relations shape consciousness, and ruling ideas present historically specific class arrangements as natural or universal. Ideology is therefore false consciousness that helps dominant interests reproduce power; it need not be a deliberate lie. Lenin broadens the term into a more neutral category of class consciousness. Because class struggle continues during the socialist phase, workers require proletarian ideology-scientific socialism-to resist bourgeois influence and organise transformation. Lenin thus converts ideology from only a mask of domination into a possible instrument of emancipation. The gain is political mobilisation; the danger is self-exemption. A party claiming uniquely correct consciousness may suppress internal criticism. Marx and Lenin therefore share the link between ideas and class struggle, but differ in range: Marx emphasises distortion by ruling ideas, whereas Lenin also legitimises an organised revolutionary ideology.

Why this earns marks: it obeys how instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Marx, Material, Ideology and Lenin), converts that evidence into analysis of does Marx's use of ideology differ from Lenin's use of the term, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that marx and Lenin therefore share the link between ideas and class struggle, but differ in range: Marx emphasises distortion by ruling ideas, whereas Lenin also legitimises an organised revolutionary ideology. At 140 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 3 - 10 marks

Question: Why can ideology be both politically necessary and dangerous? Answer in 150 words.

Demand decode: the directive why requires the answer to give the grounds, not only the description, and rank them. Fix the boundary of can ideology be both politically necessary and dangerous in the opening line, carry the argument on Ideology, Gauba's, Nationalism and Communal, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that ideology remains unavoidable in politics, but political theory is required to distinguish emancipatory mobilisation from distortion, exclusion and closed domination.

Model answer (135 words):

Ideology is politically necessary because collective action requires an interpretive frame: it names grievances, identifies agents, legitimises goals and motivates sacrifice. Gauba's examples show both sides. Nationalism may sustain anti-colonial freedom, and environmentalism may challenge destructive practices. Yet the same action-orientation can become dangerous. Communal ideology may manufacture hatred; ruling ideas may naturalise domination, as Marx argues; and a doctrine fused with state coercion may claim final truth, the threshold highlighted by Popper and Arendt. The correct conclusion is therefore neither celebration nor blanket rejection. An ideology should be tested for factual accuracy, distribution of power, treatment of dissent, proportionality of means and openness to revision. Social location may explain commitment but cannot establish truth. Ideology remains unavoidable in politics, but political theory is required to distinguish emancipatory mobilisation from distortion, exclusion and closed domination.

Why this earns marks: it obeys why instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Ideology, Gauba's, Nationalism and Communal), converts that evidence into analysis of can ideology be both politically necessary and dangerous, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that ideology remains unavoidable in

politics, but political theory is required to distinguish emancipatory mobilisation from distortion, exclusion and closed domination. At 135 words it stays inside the 150-word GS ceiling for 10 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 4 - 15 marks

Question: Examine Mannheim's sociology of knowledge and the difficulty in his proposed solution. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive examine requires the answer to test the proposition rather than describe it, weighing what supports and what weakens it. Fix the boundary of mannheim's sociology of knowledge and the difficulty in his proposed solution in the opening line, carry the argument on Mannheim, He, Marxian and Marxism, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that his sociology deepens reflexivity, but his proposed mediator must remain critic of power, not an unaccountable ruler.

Model answer (216 words):

Mannheim generalises ideology critique by arguing that all thought, not merely ruling-class thought, is socially situated. He criticises a narrow Marxian correlation between economic interest and consciousness: generations and other groups also shape styles of thought, and Marxism itself has a social location. Sociology of knowledge therefore studies how beliefs are conditioned by their historical and social setting. Mannheim distinguishes ideology, which conserves an existing order, from utopia, which mobilises change through an unrealizable projection. This framework improves political analysis because it makes criticism reflexive: the analyst must examine her own standpoint rather than only expose an opponent. The difficulty is objectivity. If all knowledge is relative to social location, how can any synthesis claim validity? Mannheim places hope in a relatively free-floating intelligentsia able to move across perspectives and construct synthetic common knowledge. The proposal encourages dialogue, but it does not fully solve the problem. Social origin explains why a belief appears plausible; it does not decide whether the belief is true. Moreover, granting social scientists authority because they claim broader vision risks intellectual absolutism. The defensible use of Mannheim is relational rather than relativist: compare perspectives, disclose social conditions and test claims through evidence and public reasoning. His sociology deepens reflexivity, but his proposed mediator must remain critic of power, not an unaccountable ruler.

Why this earns marks: it obeys examine instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Mannheim, He, Marxian and Marxism), converts that evidence into analysis of mannheim's sociology of knowledge and the difficulty in his proposed solution, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that his sociology deepens reflexivity, but his proposed mediator must remain critic of power, not an unaccountable ruler. At 216 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 5 - 15 marks

Question: Discuss Popper and Arendt on ideological closure and totalitarianism. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive discuss requires the answer to open the competing dimensions and adjudicate between them instead of listing them. Fix the boundary of popper and Arendt on ideological closure and totalitarianism in the opening line, carry the argument on Popper, Arendt, Popper's and Totalitarianism, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that their enduring contribution is thus not an ideology-free politics, but protection of plurality, fallibility and institutional revisability.

Model answer (190 words):

Popper and Arendt analyse when ideology becomes more than a contestable political commitment and turns into an instrument of total domination. Popper's open society rests on free information, criticism, fallibility and policy revision. A totalitarian order, by contrast, claims possession of final truth and uses ideology to mobilise society towards an unquestionable goal. His central insight is epistemic and institutional: because knowledge is fallible, power must permit correction. Arendt adds the historical mechanism. Totalitarianism combines an all-explanatory ideology with terror, organisation and uprooted, isolated masses. Ideological logic no longer interprets reality; coercion forces reality to conform to the doctrine. Her account therefore explains how a truth-claim becomes socially operative through atomisation and terror. The two thinkers converge on closure but differ in emphasis: Popper highlights criticism and reversible institutions, while Arendt highlights mass conditions and organised coercion. Their argument should not be overextended. Democratic politics cannot be value-free, and strong commitments are not automatically totalitarian. The danger threshold is reached when a doctrine monopolises truth, eliminates alternatives, suppresses criticism and

commands coercive enforcement. Their enduring contribution is thus not an ideology-free politics, but protection of plurality, fallibility and institutional revisability.

Why this earns marks: it obeys *critically evaluate* instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Popper, Arendt, Popper's and Totalitarianism), converts that evidence into analysis of Popper and Arendt on ideological closure and totalitarianism, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that their enduring contribution is thus not an ideology-free politics, but protection of plurality, fallibility and institutional revisability. At 190 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.

Original GS Mains Model 6 - 15 marks

Question: Critically evaluate the end-of-ideology thesis and technocratic managerialism. Answer in 250 words.

Demand decode: the directive *critically evaluate* requires the answer to apply a stated criterion, grade the claim against it and record what survives. Fix the boundary of evaluate the end-of-ideology thesis and technocratic managerialism in the opening line, carry the argument on Western, Bell, Dahrendorf and Lipset, and reserve the closing sentences for the qualification that the thesis describes a bounded convergence, not the end of value conflict or power.

Model answer (209 words):

The end-of-ideology thesis interpreted mid-twentieth-century Western affluence and institutional compromise as a decline of grand doctrinal conflict. Bell pointed to consensus around the welfare state, mixed economy, pluralism and decentralised power. Dahrendorf argued that industrial conflict had become institutionally separated from wider political conflict. Lipset described Western democracy as the good society in operation, while Rostow treated development as a common stage process. Galbraith added technocratic convergence: advanced industrial systems centralise, bureaucratised and shift power towards managerial-technical elites. These arguments identified real changes in policy style and class conflict. They did not prove that ideology ended. Titmuss highlighted concentrated economic power and deprivation beneath affluence; Mills called the thesis status-quo complacency; Macpherson retained the unresolved problem of equitable distribution; MacIntyre argued that the end claim could itself express the ideology of its time and place. Technocratic language strengthens this criticism. Expertise is necessary, but framing choices as purely technical can hide contested goals, beneficiaries, risks and alternatives. Gauba's later discussion of Fukuyama should likewise remain a post-1989 extension, not a final fact about political evolution. The balanced verdict is that older ideological polarisation may narrow, while ideology migrates into managerial assumptions, identities and distributive choices. The thesis describes a bounded convergence, not the end of value conflict or power.

Why this earns marks: it obeys *critically evaluate* instead of drifting into description, attaches each claim to named evidence (Western, Bell, Dahrendorf and Lipset), converts that evidence into analysis of evaluate the end-of-ideology thesis and technocratic managerialism, and keeps the examiner-facing qualification that the thesis describes a bounded convergence, not the end of value conflict or power. At 209 words it stays inside the 250-word GS ceiling for 15 marks.
